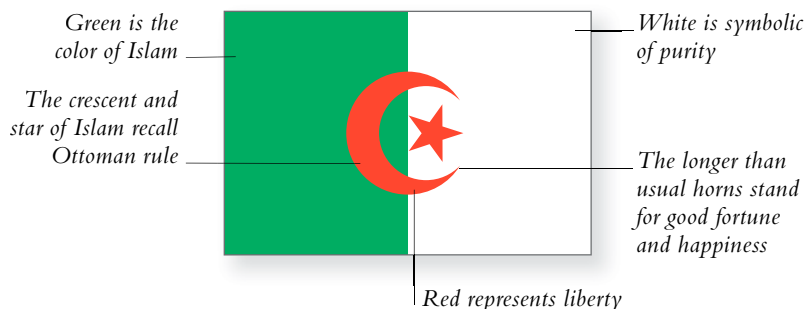


Algeria

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** July 3, 1962 **Usage:** National and Civil



Africa



Algeria was occupied by the French from 1830. Independence was achieved in 1962 after a long struggle led by the National Liberation Front.

The flag of Algeria was adopted by the National Liberation Front (*Front de Libération National*) in 1954, on the basis of an older design, created in 1928, by the nationalist leader Messali Hadj. From 1958–62 it was the flag of the Provisional Government in exile, but it was retained when independence was achieved in 1962 and has remained unchanged ever since.

SYMBOLISM IN THE FLAG

The green in the hoist is the traditional color of Islam and the white represents purity. The horns of the crescent are longer than usual and represent increase or good fortune and happiness, whilst the

whole emblem recalls the period of Ottoman rule during the 16th century and its color, red, is symbolic of liberty.

THE NAVAL ENSIGN

The naval ensign has two crossed anchors in the canton. This device is used on the naval ensigns of several Arab countries, following the example of Egypt.

THE EMBLEM OF ALGERIA

The state coat of arms is based on the well-known local emblem of the “Hand of Fatima.” It also contains the crescent and star of Islam, alongside symbols reflecting both agriculture and industry.